financial independence, the commission functions efficiently to fulfil its mandate. However, the commission wishes to have financial autonomy to purchase vehicles as the same has not been delegated.

3. **Manpower Constraints:** Since its inception, the commission has never had the full sanctioned strength as compared to the available strength. As a result, due to voluminous complaints, it is compelled to engage retired Government officers as consultants on a contract basis.

The commission struggles to cope up with the expectations of the victims of human rights violations throughout the country and is unable to fulfil its mandate of protecting and promoting human rights. It requires creation of various posts for effectively and efficiently discharging its mandate. Shortage of experienced investigating officers who are required to be provided by the Government, affected to some extent conducting spot enquiries on custodial deaths, torture, illegal detentions etc. for which sufficient number of experienced staff are required.

The Law Division, which is the backbone of the commission, also faces a lot of problems in performing its pivotal role in handling/disposing of a large number of complaints due to shortage of manpower.

In 2017, the Supreme Court expressed its concern over the shortage of manpower in the commission and directed the Government of India to take note of the concerns of the commission and remedy them at the earliest with a positive outlook.

[1]'International covenants' means the International Covenant on Civil and Political Rights and the - International Covenant on Economic, Social and Cultural Rights adopted by the General Assembly of the United Nations on December 16, 1966 and such other Covenant or Convention adopted by the General Assembly of the UN as the Central Government may specify. The Indian government acceded to these two International Covenants on April 10, 1979.

[2]T.K. Thommen, 'Human Rights Commission', Cochin University Law Review, Vol. XVII, nos. 1 and 2, March–June 1993, pp. 67–68.

[3]Justice V.S. Malimath, 'Role of Human Rights Commission', Human Rights in India: Problems and Perspectives, B.P. Singh Sehgal (ed.), Deep Publications, 1995, pp. 17–20.

[4]Under the Protection of Human Rights Act (1993), the 'armed forces' means the naval, military and air forces and includes any other armed forces of the Union.

[5]Annual Report 2019–20, National Human Rights Commission, Government of India, pp. 233–234.